



Civic Meeting Report

County Council Budget Hearings 2025, Friday, September 5th, Morning Session

Meeting Metadata	Details
Video Recording	https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=qcpGOI3-kM4
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Delaware County Municipal Meeting Report

1. Meeting Identification & Attendance

- **Call to Order & Spoken Details:** The presiding officer called the meeting back to order from recess at [00:00:20](#).
- **Attendance:**
 - **Board Members Present:** Commissioners Brand and Henry, along with Council members including Matt (Hughes), Bill (Mole), Dan, and the presiding officer.
 - **Key Officials & Staff Present:** Brad (County Treasurer), Tanya (Auditor's office staff / Auditor), Whitney and Elizabeth (Court budget staff), Emily (Court representative / Clerk staff), Nancy (Sheriff's department representative), Fred (Communications Center / 911 Director), Kelly (Public Defender staff), and Jessica.

2. Preliminary & Procedural Business

- **Ceremonial Openings:** None recorded in this segment of the reconvened session.
- **Approval of Minutes:** Not discussed during this segment.

3. Substantive Business & Board Action

- **00:00:30 Treasurer's Report & Debt Collection System (TRX)**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Brad, County Treasurer.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** The Treasurer presented information regarding the Tax Refund Exchange and Compliance System (TRX), an Indiana state program administered via Trust Indiana and the State Treasurer's office. The program allows the county to intercept state tax refunds for individuals who owe debt (such as property taxes or court costs) over \$25, passing a \$20 fee onto the debtor. Registration has no initial cost to the county. The board discussed implementation timelines for January. Additionally, the Treasurer discussed establishing a revolving line of credit (estimated around \$6M to \$10M at roughly 6% interest) to cover mid-year and end-of-year operating cash flow gaps, noting that April and May historically see operating balances drop to roughly \$2.2 million prior to semi-annual tax draws.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Informational presentation; no formal vote taken at this time.
- **00:23:53 Court Budgets & Staffing Adjustments**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Whitney, Elizabeth, and Emily.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Court representatives presented updated figures and salary line adjustments across various court budgets, pre-trial, probation, and CASA programs. Reductions in benefits (FICA, PERF, life and long-term disability) and specific line additions (such as a Family Resource Coordinator program coordinator grant adjustment of \$2,640) were reviewed. Emily reported that outstanding court costs and fines across the five courts totaled \$4,837,545 as of June 2024.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Reviewed and integrated into the ongoing budget balancing process.
- **00:37:28 Sheriff's Department & Jail Budget / Fuel Lines**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Nancy and Sheriff's department representatives, alongside Council members.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** The board discussed reducing the operating supplies fuel line by \$25,000 (bringing the total reduction to \$28,000 while reallocating \$3,000 to vehicle lines to fully fund a police vehicle). Potential vehicle funding via the Redevelopment Commission (DCRC) was debated. Additionally, anticipated federal inmate revenue for 2025 was increased by \$100,000 (bringing the estimated total to \$600,000 for the final half of the year).
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Consensus reached to adjust the fuel and vehicle lines and incorporate the increased revenue estimate.
- **00:51:35 Commissioners' Report: Health Insurance, Clinics & Liability**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Commissioners Brand and Henry, alongside Council members.

- **Deliberation Summary:** Extensive discussion was held regarding county health insurance plans, third-party administrators (Apex vs. McGriff), and onsite clinic costs (transitioning from IU Health to Marathon). Projected healthcare cost savings were estimated at \$350,000 from the clinic transition and \$500,000 from switching third-party administrators (totaling an estimated \$850,000 in potential savings). The board also discussed employee premium tier structures (e.g., shifting from a 92/8 county-to-employee split toward an 85/15 or 80/20 split) and reducing liability insurance budget lines from \$2 million down to \$1.6 million (\$400,000 reduction).
- **Action & Vote Disposition:** Direction given to incorporate the estimated healthcare savings and liability insurance reductions into the working budget figures.
- **01:46:37 Public Defender Budget & Operational Costs**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Kelly (Public Defender).
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Kelly presented updated FICA figures and discussed professional services, transcription fees, and outside attorney appeal costs (noting an upcoming \$12,500 bill). The board discussed whether to reduce operating lines or maintain current figures to avoid mid-year funding requests.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Figures reviewed and updated for FICA/PERF; operating lines maintained.
- **02:03:39 Communications Center (911) & Employee Compensation Proposals**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Fred (Communications Director) and Bill (Mole).
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Fred addressed staffing levels, minimum staffing mandates, overtime realities, and the multi-year dispatcher salary plan designed to reach target compensation levels (\$51,000 annual salary). Bill proposed a flat \$1,000 raise structure for non-supervisory employees across Communications (911), EMS, County Building Maintenance, and Bridge & Highway, totaling approximately \$82,000 for county general. Fred clarified that his operating budget has no remaining padding, and savings in salary lines only occur due to temporary vacancies rather than overbudgeting.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Informational and deliberation phase; no final vote taken.

4. Open Public Comment / Citizen Forum

No formal open citizen forum or general public comment period was conducted during this business work session; all commentary originated from board members, elected officials, and department heads.

5. Administrative Updates & Adjournment

- **Staff / Board Announcements:**

- The board noted the efficiency of utilizing OpenGov and digital spreadsheets for real-time budget adjustments.
 - Department heads were reminded to submit formal give-back numbers and budget inquiries through DC budget.
 - **Adjournment:**
 - **Disposition:** The meeting was recessed for lunch.
 - **Timestamp / Time Stated:** 02:23:06 <U+2014> The board voted/agreed to break for lunch and reconvene promptly at **2:00 PM**.
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